

CA PES MONTHLY BRIEF

DECEMBER 2025

ISSUE # 7

“

ADVANCING INDEPENDENT
DISCOURSE ON ASIA-PACIFIC
& EURASIA



PAKISTAN-RUSSIA EURASIAN FORUM 2025

CA PES along with the Zhirinovskiy University of World Civilizations and Federal Urdu University of Arts, Science & Technology (FUUAST), Islamabad conducted the Pakistan-Russia Eurasian Forum 2025 in Moscow on 16-17 December 2025. The objective of the Forum was to strengthen Pakistan-Russia relations through public diplomacy, academic dialogue, and people-to-people engagement. The forum brought together senior officials from the Russian and Pakistani Ministry of Foreign Affairs as well as leading scholars from both countries.



Exploring Collaborative Programs between CAPES & PPMI

CA PES met with Rahmat Hindiarta Kusuma, Minister Counsellor at the Embassy of Indonesia in Islamabad and Indonesian Student Association Islamabad (PPMI) met in Indonesia Corner at National Library Islamabad to discuss avenues of mutual cooperation. They discussed student exchanges, hosting of joint events and signing of MoU between CAPES and PPMI. Mr. Rahmat also invited CAPES to organize seminars, talks, and events at Indonesia corner in collaboration with the Indonesian Embassy.



LITTERATERRA INTERNATIONAL CONFERENCE

CA PES along with the Ural State Pedagogical University, Russia, hosted the LitteraTerra International Conference. The event brought students from Pakistan and Russia to explore the most influential literary figures and movements in their respective nations. The conference aimed to increase understanding of the rich literary traditions of both countries.



Russia–Pakistan: Overview of the Modern Stage of Bilateral Relations

CAPES along with the Embassy of the Russian Federation in Islamabad hosted a high-level academic and policy forum on December 18, 2025, at the Russian Embassy, bringing together approximately 40 distinguished scholars, academicians, and practitioners from across Pakistan. The forum featured a series of academic interventions highlighting diverse dimensions of cooperation.



CAPES EXPERT TALK WITH DR SAIRA AQUIL (VICE PRESIDENT CAPES)

CAPES hosted an in-house discussion with Dr. Saira Aquil, Vice President of CAPES and Assistant Professor, Quaid-e-Azam University. In recent years, the global order has shifted from unipolarity to complex multipolarity. This shift has created new challenges and opportunities for small and middle powers in the Asia Pacific region.

CAPES EXPERT TALK WITH MICHAEL HUANG (PHD SCHOLAR, USA)

CAPES organized an in-house discussion with a PhD scholar at the Department of Political Science at the University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, Michael Huang. Foreign aid has always been used as a development tool. But in recent times, it has also become a core instrument of public diplomacy. Great powers hinge on shaping public sentiment.



CAPES EXPERT TALK WITH ADNAN AMIR (SENIOR JOURNALIST)

CAPES hosted Adnan Amir, Senior Journalist associated with Nikkei Asia. He talked about Pakistan-Japan relations, highlighting Pakistan's importance to Japan. He expanded on the prominence of Japanese automobile companies in Pakistan, Export of IT Human Resource, as well as the export of copper and Reko Diq mine.

CAPES EXPERT TALK WITH SHABAB AKRAM (EDUCATIONAL CONSULTANT)

CAPES conducted a session with Shabab Akram, educational consultant. Mr Akram who has secured multiple scholarships in Türkiye expanded on the various scholarship opportunities for Pakistani students in Türkiye. Additionally, he also explained the application process and other relevant details of major Turkish scholarships.



India-Bangladesh rift over Hasina: What is next?

CAPES GENERAL SECRETARY
UMAIR PERVEZ KHAN
WRITES FOR DAILY SABAH



<https://www.dailysabah.com/opinion/op-ed/india-bangladesh-rift-over-hasina-what-is-next>

"Bangladesh's International Crimes Tribunal (ICT), in its recent decision, has awarded a death sentence and life imprisonment on different accounts, including "crimes against humanity," to the country's former prime minister, Sheikh Hasina. This has been followed up by a formal request of Bangladesh's interim government to India for the extradition of the convicted, as she has been in exile in India since the popular uprising against her government last year. While India has not commented clearly on the request, it is likely to respond negatively."



What drives Students' Educational Choices From West to East

CAPES RESEARCHER
YUSRA SARWAR
WRITES FOR STRATHEIA

<https://stratheaia.com/what-drives-students-educational-choices-from-west-to-east/>

"The USA, UK, Canada, and Australia are known as the Big Four destinations of global education. But amid changing geopolitical dynamics and economic competition, a clear shift is being observed in students' educational choices to consider the option of studying in the Asia-Pacific universities, particularly in China, Japan, South Korea, and Malaysia. This change in preferences is caused by easing of visa policies, lack of educational scholarships in Western countries, improvement in the educational standards of Asia-Pacific universities, affordability, and CPEC."



PAK-PACIFIC BRIEF

- Japan funds eyecare facility in Abbottabad under GGP program.
- Prabowo Pushes Trade Rebalance in First Visit to Pakistan and signs seven cooperation agreements.
- Indonesian President Receives Pakistan's Highest Civil Award.
- Pakistan-Japan Business Forum highlights bilateral investment exceeding \$1.3 billion.
- Pakistan inaugurates first PV module testing lab with Korean grant support.
- AFL Pakistan Women's Championship strengthens Pak-Australia ties.
- Pakistan's Science Minister met KOICA representatives to expand collaboration.
- Foreign Minister Gilani thanked Australia for hosting 20,000 Pakistani students.
- Korea Embassy Holds GKS Alumni Session in Islamabad.
- Pakistan reaffirms long-term trade partnership with Japan at Tokyo Business Seminar 2025.
- Indonesia and Pakistan Fast-Track CEPA Upgrade by 2027.
- Pak-New Zealand Business Council formed to boost bilateral trade and commercial engagement.
- Japan Pledges US\$3.5 Million to Support Pakistan's Polio Eradication.
- PM Shehbaz Reaffirms Solidarity with Australia After Bondi Beach Attack.

When leverage outpaces strategy

CAPES NON-RESIDENT FELLOW
MUHAMMAD UMAR,
WRITES FOR THE NEWS

<https://www.thenews.pk/print/1388141-when-leverage-outpaces-strategy>



"The evolution of Russia's economic policies from Lenin to Putin reflects an effort to respond to internal stagnation and shifting geopolitical pressures. The post-Soviet period brought its own contradictions. Present-day Russia, particularly in the context of protracted war in Ukraine, is navigating a complex terrain where economic governance must reconcile war-driven expenditures, sanctions, and resource nationalism."



PAK-EURASIA BRIEF

- Kazakhstan Envoy Calls for Stronger Legal Cooperation.
- Uzbek FM Bakhtiyor confirms visit of Uzbek President.
- Belarus-Pakistan discuss intensifying parliamentary ties.
- Pakistan plans \$14.5m halal meat exports to Tajikistan.
- Russian diplomat delivers lecture at the Pakistan Foreign Service Academy.
- Tajikistan Cultural Festival held in Islamabad.
- PM Shehbaz Sharif visits Turkmenistan for peace forum.
- Pakistan, Uzbekistan agree to extend PTA.
- Kyrgyz President Japarov first official Pakistan visit.
- Pakistan-Russia to revive Pakistan Steel Mills
- Pakistan, Turkmenistan explore trade routes via Gwadar.
- Russia increases scholarships for Pakistani students.
- Pakistan, Turkmenistan explore new trade routes via Gwadar port.
- Tajik Education Minister praises ATSM for bolstering Pak-Tajikistan.